



Everything is ILLUMINATED



PLURALIST ETHOS: A pavement makes a multi-religious statement

INDIANS DRAW ON HINDU HERITAGE IN MORAL AND SOCIAL RELATIONS, MUSLIM HERITAGE IN MUSIC, AND SECULAR WESTERN THOUGHT IN POLITICS

BY BHIKHU PAREKH

Political communities are fragile entities. It takes decades to build them. And just when we think their unity is secure, they begin to show cracks and even unravel in a remarkably short period of time. Who would have thought that the erstwhile Yugoslav federation, born around the same time as India, would disintegrate within three years amidst so much bloodshed? And that the Soviet Union, with a much longer history and an intense process of consolidation under Stalin and his successors, would collapse just as quickly? Even the United Kingdom may see Scottish secession if the country isn't careful.

By a strange miracle, of the kind that the Hindu epics and Puranas write about, India continues to main intact. We did, no doubt, come